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THIS BEAUTY QUEEN IS A BARRIER BREAKER

A hearing-impaired school girl, 16-year-old Saarika Jagadeesh has been crowned Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026 **P4**



A GREEN CARPET ROLLED OUT TO NATURE ENTHUSIASTS

Bushwalk corridor, a community-built green space along the Buckingham Canal serves as a venue for guided bushwalks and birding sessions **P6**



Santhomeans of 1976 to celebrate golden jubilee reunion today

The 1976 batch of Santhome Higher Secondary School will celebrate its Golden Jubilee Reunion on June 7 from 4 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. at the school auditorium.

As part of the celebrations, the alumni batch will donate 12 smart boards to their alma mater. The smart boards will be inaugurated during the function, says a press release.

The batch has also taken the initiative to establish and register an alumni association and launch a dedicated website to facilitate online membership registration and related banking transactions for alumni activities.

The 1976 batch originally comprised around 130 students across one English-medium section and two Tamil-medium sections.

Through extensive efforts, the organisers identified 65 former students, who are now connected through a WhatsApp group. Sadly, around 25 batchmates are no longer with them, the release adds.

The reunion is expected to draw nearly 80 alumni members along with their family members.

A special feature of the event will be the felicitation of 11 former teaching staff members and two office assistants who served the batch during their school years.

The event will also be attended by members of the newly formed Alumni Association committee, selected members of the current school staff, and invited senior and junior alumni of the institution.

Related story on Page 5

Residents throng temporary MLA office in the evenings

M. SRINATH

Residents of neighbourhoods in the Mylapore constituency have started thronging a new address to make their grievances heard. The temporary MLA office functions from this address on C.P. Ramaswamy Road, which is the first floor of a Greater Chennai Corporation shopping complex.

This complex is situated opposite the building where the old MLA office was located. Residents have been visiting the temporary MLA office in the evenings to meet the Mylapore MLA P. Venkataramanan, who also holds a ministerial portfolio in the government, and submit petitions relating to civic infrastructure and local concerns.



Residents at the temporary MLA office and (below) the old MLA office which is set for demolition. PHOTOS: M. SRINATH

Incomplete work at Marina beach road



These two images were taken opposite University Guest House on Marina beach road. After completing the cable laying work, the dug-up portion was not covered. Concrete stones that were removed are also lying nearby, posing a risk to pedestrians. TEXT AND PHOTOS: R. KASIM RAZVI FROM MYLAPORE

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Ration shop at Mundakanni Amman Koil Street in a deplorable state



MOHAMED AJMAL

These images show the extremely poor condition of the ration shop located at Mundakanni Amman Koil Street in Mylapore.

The state of the ration shop is a matter of concern to residents depending on this public distribution outlet for their essential commodities.

During my recent visits to the ration shop, I noticed that the ceiling was cracked and walls damaged, underlining poor upkeep of the building. During the rainy season, the condition becomes even more

alarming, as leakage and poor drainage pose additional risks.

The ration shop serves a large number of economically weak families, senior citizens and daily wage earners who visit it regularly to collect essential supplies. Unfortunately, the current state of the building does not reflect the importance of this public service facility.

The maintenance of this building seems to have been overlooked for a considerable period of time. Immediate inspection and renovation are necessary to prevent further deterioration and ensure the safety of the public.

The new community hall.
PHOTO: SRINATH M

A spanking new community hall on CPR Salai

The work is expected to be completed in the first week of July and the inauguration is slated for the second week



M. SRINATH

The community hall at C.P. Ramaswamy could be mistaken for something else by anyone out of touch with Mylapore for one year. During this period, the old community hall, noticeably antediluvian, was razed to the ground, and in its place, a new facility raised. Despite restrained ornamentation, the building is sufficiently swanky and way different from its slightly anachronistic predecessor. It belongs to a new and rapidly growing category of community halls across Greater Chennai Corporation limits that come with a premium air, combining aesthetics with functionality.

The final touch is being added to the newly constructed community hall, expected to be inaugurated in the second week of July.

The facility is being built at ₹7 crore, the break-up being ₹5.5 cr coming in as MP fund and the rest as Corporation capital fund, according to a Greater Chennai Corporation source.

The area within the compound wall measures 1013 sq.m. The ground floor consists of a kitchen and parking lot, accounting for 639 sq.m. The first floor accounts for 639 sq.m, consisting of a dining hall, a wash area and a storeroom; on the second floor, also spread across 639 sq.m, is found a marriage hall with two rooms.

On 430 sq.m of the third floor, four rooms have been constructed.

The facility is fully air-conditioned with a centralised system.

The work is expected to be completed on or before July 15. According to the GCC source, the pricing for the use of this space is yet to be decided upon.



READERS WRITE

‘Restore Nageswara Rao Park’s **damaged plaque**’

E. MURALIDHARAN

The condition of the commemorative marble plaque at Nageswara Rao Park in Mylapore has left me with great disappointment. It served as a rare record of the opening of the park and the people behind it.

My maternal grandfather, Ekambara Naicker, was among those responsible for establishing this park, one of the biggest in the neighbourhood in those days. He was a freedom fighter and a councillor in the first Council of the Corporation of Madras. Last month, after I noticed that this plaque was removed and the pillar broken, I spoke to the site engineer undertaking the renovation work, who informed me that the plaque was kept safely at their store at the Dental College in Park Town and would be placed in the park after the completion of renovation work.

There is so much heritage and



history in the park, and I am hoping to meet the new MLA P. Venkataramanan to ensure the plaque is restored to its rightful place.

Actually, there were two plaques, one placed on the left and the other on the right side of the entrance to the park. On the left was the park inauguration plaque

and on the right was the plaque stating the names of the land donors for the park. I am told one is missing and the other is damaged.

It showed this park was raised by the Corporation of Madras on the old Arathakuttai. Donated by: Smt. Ramayamma (wife of late K. Nageswararai Pandulu); Sri. M. Nai-



▼ The two commemorative plaques were seen until the renovation of the park began. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT AND M. SRINATH



niappa Mudaliar; and Sri.G.Aravamuda Aiyangar.

I request the MLA to look into this act of vandalism, and restore the commemorative plaques to the

rightful place in the park at the earliest.

E. Muralidharan is a resident of Bheemanna Garden Street in Alwarpet

You can be our **volunteer writer**

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number



The lane off Taylor's Road in Kilpauk. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Road in school zone **unfriendly to pedestrians**’

This lane (as the image shows) which lacks a name is off Taylor's Road in Kilpauk. It is an approach road to a school and it also houses

a quarters of the police department. But it is untidy and unkempt. The road margins are pedestrian-unfriendly.

Besides, the ongoing stormwater drain construction has further narrowed the road. There is no alternative route to access the

school. I request Greater Chennai Corporation to complete the drain work and restore the road at the earliest.

Anosh Nishter Sadat is a resident of Perambur

Students from Queen Mary's and University of Madras **show tech prowess**

The two are among the national toppers in Samsung Innovation Campus for their innovations in agriculture and urban mobility

Two students from Chennai have been named among the top performers nationally in Samsung Innovation Campus 2025, a technology skilling programme that trains young people in emerging fields such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), Internet of Things (IoT), Coding and Big Data.

Sivani K, a second-year B.Sc. student of Queen Mary's College, and



Sivani K and Santhosh Kumar S.

Santhosh Kumar S, a first-year M.Sc. student from the University of Madras, were among the four national toppers recognised this year. They were selected from a pool of 20,000 students from across the country, said a release.

As part of the course, Sivani developed an IoT-enabled Smart Traffic Management System aimed at improving traffic flow and reducing congestion in urban areas. The project explores how connected technologies can help cities manage growing mobility challenges more efficiently.

Santhosh created an AI-powered pest detection and control model designed to help farmers identify crop threats at an early stage.

The students were felicitated at Samsung India's headquarters in

Gurugram by JB Park, President & CEO, Samsung Southwest Asia. The students also got to explore Samsung's innovation ecosystem through visits to Samsung R&D Institute, Noida, Samsung R&D Institute Delhi and Samsung Design Delhi.

Samsung Innovation Campus is part of Samsung's global citizenship initiative and focuses on providing technology training, project-based learning and industry exposure to young learners.

For SIC 2025, Samsung India felicitated 30 outstanding students from across the country, awarding each topper ₹1 lakh for exceptional performance in each of the four courses – Artificial Intelligence (AI), Coding & Programming, Internet of Things (IoT) and Big Data, added the release.

This beauty queen is a barrier breaker

A hearing-impaired school girl, 16-year-old Saarikha Jagadeesh has been crowned Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026. Her answer at the beauty pageant truthfully reflects what she does off stage: using her earnings from her modelling assignments to support children with special needs



▼ Saarikha Jagadeesh being crowned Miss Teen Tamil Nadu by Miss Universe India Manika Vishwakarma at a pageant held on May 29. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

tra Hearing Care under whose care she is since the age of two. "To build her confidence, I used to encourage her to look at the mirror and say 'she looks like a queen'," says Srividya. That was important because Saarikha did face bullying at school. Under the banner of "Global Raising Challengers Organisation", Saarikha has given whatever she earned through modelling assignments to support other special needs children. Her first major stage event was at age of 11, where she won the "Junior Miss India" organised by Madarase Universal. There has been no looking back since then. Junior Miss Fab Star, Grand Gala Fashion Week, photo shoots for advertisements and a small role in a film only boosted her confidence.

For the World Fashion Week in Dubai in 2024, she took along three other children with special needs to walk the ramp along with her, training many of them to face the stage confidently.

In 2025, she conducted Tiranga, an inclusive event where 214 children walked the ramp to enter the London Book of Records.

Saarikha admits that making friends was not easy and she took the taunts as a challenge to prove others wrong.

"As a young girl with hearing disability, I know what my parents had to go through to meet my medical expense; the medication that was needed to improve my speech," says Saarikha. "Modelling gave me confidence. I want other children like me who cannot walk, speak, see and those with Down's Syndrome to achieve their dreams," says Saarikha who wants to pursue a career in law.

Srividya remembers the tough search that had to be undertaken to find a swimming coach for her. Finally, an academy took it as a challenge to train Saarikha under water.

The family has a long list of people to thank starting with their former neighbour Kalpana D. Kumar, a speech pathologist. Kalpana nudged them to start early inter-

vention for the little girl.

Behind the young model's elegant wardrobe is Sasirekha, chief designer at Sasi's Bangalore Designer, who generously designs her costumes free of charge. A. Saffiberry, founder of Madrase Universal, who saw potential in Saarikha at 11 and continues to mentor her; and Malik, a casting director, who gave her an opportunity to act in *Goat* movie.

Actor Nayana Sai, founder of Southernwoods Model Academy, who has been training Saarikha, says she is a keen observer and a fast learner who can execute things the way you want.

"Even if she is not able to hear certain words, she tries to grasp my lip movement and respond. At times when her hearing aid stopped functioning, she observes and picks up. Pronouncing 'R' or 'S' word has been difficult but she worked on it," says Nayana, who has trained more than 150 models.

Agreeing with Nayana, Saffiberry says Silambam moves she performed during the talent round she had learnt in just two weeks time. It gave the audience goosebumps, he says.

Srividya says her husband, Jagadeesh V, was not keen on modelling but never discouraged Saarikha. Jagadeesh ferries her to the many classes she attends.



LIFY THOMAS

Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026 Saarikha Jagadeesh's answer in the question-and-answer round was in earnest, and no empty rhetoric. What she has done in the past points unerringly to that conclusion.

Asked what she would invent to help the world and why, 16-year-old Saarikha replied:

"I would not invent. Instead, I would create opportunities for the underprivileged and the differently abled because I believe that true beauty lies in helping others. Through my initiative, the Global Raising Challengers Organisation I am doing that."

Saarikha had been diagnosed with bilateral profound hearing

loss as an infant, and the combination early intervention and modern technology has ensured that the world of sound was not shut out for her.

After early intervention at Balavidyalaya, the school for young deaf children in Adyar, till the age of five, Saarikha joined regular schooling starting with St. Francis International School in Kolapakkam followed by Velammal Bodhi Campus in Mugulivakkam. The hearing aid is her constant companion and her lifeline through which she does everything like a normal child. Saarikha is a Class XI student of Ology Tech School in Mugulivakkam.

Saarikha got started on modelling early.

Behind Saarikha's foray into modelling was her mother Srividya J., and audiologist Dr Rajarajan of As-

23 participants at grand finale



▼ The winners of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 seen with (second from right) Nandini Nagaraj.

The grand finale of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 was held on May 29, 2026 at Taj Fisherman's Cove, bringing together aspiring contestants from across the state in a celebration of beauty, confi-

dence, talent and empowerment.

Twenty-three contestants were in the fray across Miss Universe Tamil Nadu and Miss Teen Tamil Nadu categories.

The panel of judges included

Amjad Khan, director of franchise operations, MUI; Nikhil Anand, national director Miss Universe India; Vaamshi Uday, Miss Universe Karnataka 2025 winner; Kamakshi, Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2025 winner; and Manika Vishwakarma, Miss Universe India.

According to a release, the winners of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 are Vaishnavi (winner); Pramiti (first runner-up); and Nikita (second runner-up). Saarikha was declared winner of the Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026.

The event showcased not only beauty and fashion but confidence, leadership, and individuality, providing a platform for young women to inspire and make a meaningful impact, said the release.

Nandini Nagaraj, state director for Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, who organised the event, said the success of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 marks another milestone in empowering women and nurturing future ambassadors who represent grace, intelligence, and purpose.



C.T. Natesan, captain of Santhome Higher Secondary School receiving the T.N.C.A. Silver Jubilee Trophy from R.B. Alaganan, vice president, T.N.C.A. in 1983; former Santhome coach Srinivasa Rao with cricketer Sai Sudharsan; and (below) playback singer Unnikrishnan who cherishes his cricketing days at Santhome in the 1980s. PHOTOS: THE HINDU ARCHIVES & SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHAN

When two Santhome school watchers meet, cricket enters their conversation as surely as weather does when two Englishmen have a chat. The topic for this column came up on the sidelines of a discussion about the Golden Jubilee Reunion of 1976 batch of Santhome Higher Secondary School slated for June 7. While sifting through the accomplishments of the 1976 batch, the inevitable question was asked: “Any alumni from the 1976 batch made it to the national or state cricket team?” In the 1970s, Santhome school was on the way to cricketing greatness, but not until the mid-1980s would it be spoken of in glowing terms for its cricket. From the 1980s, the school produced cricketing giants who have embellished Tamil Nadu and India teams. Never mind that the 1976 batch cannot contribute to the topic. Recollections of Santhome cricket’s golden decades seem to have perennial topicality never paling on Madras nostalgia hunters, even if the memory synapse fires from the 1980s.

T20 before T20 arrived

Before the T20 fever gripped cricket aficionados, Santhome Higher Secondary School was in the grip of an even more truncated form of cricket. Practice matches were always clipped short, often into one-fourth the span of the current T20 match, encouraging players to go hell for leather and the bowlers to “deliver” in the ridiculously few deliveries they got to bowl. “Players were trained to score quickly and make every over count,” recalls former coach Srinivasa Rao. The sense of urgency while wielding the willow as well as the leather was particularly evident in the 1983-84 season, when at the Swami

Santhome cricket lore never runs out of fizz

The 1976 batch of Santhome Higher Secondary School will be in the spotlight today, its members having a gala Golden Jubilee Reunion on the campus. Never mind that none of the alumni from this batch made it to either the state or national team; the occasion still warrants a toast to the school’s cricketing culture. Retro Route tracks the high points of the institution’s cricketing history



Vivekananda Tournament, the finals was an all-Santhome affair. The school had entered two teams, Santhome ‘A’ and Santhome ‘B’, and these teams set up the summit clash. How they made it to the finals is in itself a plot that a 17th century writer from England would give his goose feather quill-wielding arm for. The finals left Santhome’s cheerleaders in the gallery

in a peculiar situation. In fact, the spectator zone was largely occupied by Santhomeans. When a boundary was hit, there was only cheers, no frowns. When a wicket fell, again only cheer, no glum faces at all, except for those of the opponents on the field. After all, the trophy was intact from the very beginning, sealed for Santhome; the spectators’ fingernails were intact

too, no nail-chewing nervousness.

Old bonds stay strong

You can take someone out of Santhome, but not Santhome out of them, according to Srinivasa Rao. He does not coach Santhome school anymore, but continues to feel a strong pull towards those gates. Every day, on his walk, he stops by the school and shares a word or two of cricketing wisdom with the boys slugging it out in a routine practice match.

An unusual admission policy

Behind Santhome’s cricketing dominance stood a group of people who put cricket on a pedestal. While recalling those Halcyon days, P. Unnikrishnan, the renowned playback singer and proud Santhomean, speaks fondly about then principal Brother Camillus, whose affection for cricket was impossible to miss. With a laugh, Unnikrishnan remembers how Brother Camillus had a unique yet simple admission policy that was at loggerheads with commonly followed protocols. “If one could play cricket, the rest could be sorted out

later.” Things were as simple as that in Brother Camillus’s world. And that meant Unnikrishnan’s report card from his previous school, Asan Memorial, stayed unseen. Unnikrishnan and Santhome had met mid-way, he looking for an environment conducive for growing his skills as a top-order batsman and a wicket keeper, and the school seeking a talent that would slot smoothly into a cricket restructuring plan it had drawn up. Unnikrishnan points out that the school was restructuring its cricket programme in the early 1980s. It did not take long for the institution to see results on account of this exercise.

“We won almost every tournament in the 1980s,” he notes. According to the musician, part of Santhome’s cricketing success in the 1980s derived from a scientific approach to the sport, partly epitomised by S. Ramakrishnan who would later come to be known for his pioneering work in video and data analytics in cricket. “Ramakrishnan was my senior by a year and my captain in the Santhome team,” the singer says. Today, the role of the support staff is often underlined when a team excels; Santhome

has a robust support team, and Unnikrishnan has laudatory words for a few of them, including coach CPS Mami and Md. Hussain (manager of Santhome cricket team), who actually spotted Unnikrishnan’s cricketing talent and brought him to Santhome. Champion teams win laurels not only by the strength of their own abilities, but also those of their arch rivals, clashes with them sharpening their skills. Unnikrishnan names Santhome’s prime rivals in the 1980s: its neighbour on Santhome High Road, St. Bede’s and The Hindu Higher Secondary School in Triplicane.

Retro Route
is a column
that resurfaces
the past that was
Madras

A green carpet rolled out to nature enthusiasts

Bushwalk corridor, a community-built green space along the Buckingham Canal behind House of Hiranandani Upscale in Egattur on Old Mahabalipuram Road serves as a venue for guided bushwalks and birding sessions, as it did on World Environment Day

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

A patch of burnt soil, damaged drip irrigation pipes and blackened tree trunks now mark a section of what is called Bushwalk corridor along Buckingham Canal in Egattur, thanks to a fire that swept through it roughly a fortnight ago. Residents of House of Hiranandani Upscale had ploughed in considerable resources to build this green corridor, located in the space along the Canal, behind the towers. And they would have to allocate more resources to repair and restore the damaged elements. But this setback did not hold The Bushwalk Trust which manages the corridor from going ahead with a public event on World Environment Day (June 5), a walk down the Bushwalk corridor offered to both residents and guests. From time to time, the 'green' carpet is rolled out to nature enthusiasts from anywhere.

Along the way, the corridor had grown massive enough to make administration by a trust necessary. The corridor supports 12,000 plants and serves as a space for guided bushwalks and birding sessions.

The seeds of a green corridor were sown ironically during a "dry" period, the pandemic. Around 3,000 saplings of Arjuna tree had been planted along the Buckingham canal under a Tamil Nadu government urban forestry initiative. "There was no mechan-



ism to ensure their survival," recalls Shanthi Jothilingam, Treasurer of Bushwalk Trust. "Many residents assumed the agency that planted the saplings would continue maintaining them. But when that did not happen, a few volun-

teers stepped in." Among them was R. Shankar, a resident whose commitment would eventually shape the future of the landscape. Having left his job during the pandemic, Shankar found himself spending more time within the community



Images from the World Environment Day walk at Bushwalk corridor; a male Golden oriole photographed at the corridor.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT AND E. ARUN KUMAR

and became increasingly concerned about the fate of the saplings.

"We felt that if we did not act at that stage, thousands of saplings would simply be lost," he recalls. Residents pooled in funds, hired water tankers and spent weekends watering the saplings. The terrain was uneven and covered in dense undergrowth, making access difficult. Volunteers often filled drums with water and carried buckets across the site to reach the plants.

"It was physically demanding work," says Shanthi. "People would come before work, after work or whenever they found time and chip in."

Saplings grew, so did the scope of the initiative. Through Exnora International, the group established ties with Gayatri Trust, which later extended financial sup-

port. Around the same time, Shankar identified an opportunity to utilise groundwater emerging from nearby construction activity instead of allowing it to flow into the Buckingham Canal. The water was tested, found suitable for irrigation and channelled into a pond constructed with external support. From there, a drip irrigation system and sprinklers were installed across the site, dramatically reducing dependence on water tankers and creating a more sustainable maintenance model.

As the project expanded, residents realised the initiative needed a formal structure. The Bushwalk Trust was subsequently established as a legally registered trust, enabling it to receive institutional funding, employ dedicated gardeners and manage its finances transparently.

Children are often at the centre of programmes by The Bushwalk Trust. Plantation drives encourage them to plant saplings and monitor their growth, while nature-based activities foster a deeper connection with the environment.

The corridor has also emerged as an unexpected biodiversity hotspot. E. Arun Kumar, a resident naturalist who has been documenting wildlife in the area since 2021, says the habitat now supports a rich variety of resident and migratory bird species.

"We have documented 176 bird species here," he says. "Every few months, we organise bird walks, particularly during winter when migratory birds arrive. Many children who attend develop a lasting interest in birdwatching and nature."



PLAN YOUR WEEK

Exhibition of multilingual picture books



The Library at Goethe-Institut/Max Mueller Bhavan Chennai is conducting an “immersive exploration of big questions in life through children’s literature”. The event titled ‘Litsophical’ features a curated exhibition by Rhea Kuthoore and Jigar Bhalani (*in picture*), facilitators of Philosophy with Children. Participants will also be taken around an exhibition featuring multilingual picture books and thought-provoking questions and activities that engage with the philosophical self.

Litsophical is happening from June 10 to June 20 at Goethe-Institut, Rutland Gate, 5th Street, Nungambakkam.

For details and to register, WhatsApp 9342267878 or 8816933078 (Rhea)

Help for the new academic year



Kalaa Manjari Creativity Center has launched new batches for the academic year, offering Global Art, chess, phonetics, Tamil and Hindi tuitions, karate, English handwriting, homework assistance, and academic support for all subjects.

The programmes can be

availed by children above five years of age and will be led by trained professionals with a focus on skill-based learning, creativity, confidence-building, and academic excellence.

The center is located at 25/13, Second Street, East Abhiramapuram. For details, call 98402 25570, 91766 10660.

Wellness workshop in Chepauk

Mind Cafe is conducting an emotional wellness experience workshop on June 13 at 153, Bells Road.

The workshop is designed to help participants pause, unwind, and reconnect with themselves through a guided creative journey. No prior painting skills are required.

Blood donation camp at two venues

As part of World Blood Donors Day (June 14), Aalam Group of Chennai Cyclists and Chromepet Cheetahs are organising a blood donation camp on June 14 at two venues.

They are: BBR Community Hall in Chromepet (contact Sankar Sakthivel 91760 30847) and the other at the Institute of Child Health Hospital in Egmore (contact Lokesh 97899 82110).

Nominations invited for Teachers’ Awards

The Shiv Nadar Foundation, in partnership with Said Business School, University of Oxford, has invited entries for the inaugural edition of ‘India’s Best Teachers’ Awards 2026’ The awards are for educators of Geography, Business Studies and Entrepreneurship, Computer Science, Economics, Physics, English, Environmental Sciences, and Mathematics, teaching classes IX to XII.

Applications will be assessed on subject expertise, innovation in teaching methodology, impact on student learning outcomes, and leadership within schools and communities, stat-

ed a release from the foundation.

School principals and heads of government and private schools can submit nominations until July 31 to <https://indiateacherawards.evalato.com>.

Shortlisted finalists will be invited to participate in the final stage of the awards process at Shiv Nadar University, New Delhi - New Capital Region on September 4 and 5.

Award recipients will receive national recognition and a fully funded scholarship to participate in a one-week learning and development programme at Said Business School.

Works of 18 artists on display

Works of 18 well-known and emerging artists are showcased at Art Cube Gallery in Virugambakkam. Titled ‘First Impressions’ – a celebration of original art, emerging talent, and artistic excellence, this is the debut exhibition at this gallery.

Featuring paintings, sculptures, mixed-media works, photography,

serigraphs, folk art, abstracts, limited-edition prints, and collector exclusives, First Impressions offers visitors an encounter with artistic innovation and craftsmanship, said a release.

The 18 artists include A. V. Ilango, Asma Menon, Dakshayani B., Dhiyaneshwaran VR, Hemalatha, Jacob Jebaraj, Karthikeyan Pitchai-

mallian, K.G. Narendrababu, Manisha Raju, N. K. Baskaran, N. S. Manoharan, Raju Durshettiwar, S. Saravanan, Saroja Ravi, Selva Senthil Kumar, Thejomaye Menon and Varalakshmi B.

The exhibition is on till June 10; 10 a.m. to 5 p.m and is free for all. Art Cube Gallery is at Plot 13, 2nd Street, Elango Nagar, Virugambakkam. For details, call Aishna at 9444118484 / 9360200520

Cricket tournament in Adyar

The P.S. Nataraja Sarma Memorial Tournament began at Gandhi Nagar Cricket and Sports Club on June 6. The 50 overs - a - side tournament will feature a total of eights teams. The finals will be held on June 27.

Elders care centre launched

Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospital has launched Dr. K Elder Care Assisted Living.

Located in Nanganallur, the centre aims to address the growing need for professional elder care, assisted living, and post-hospital recovery services.

Dr. V. S. Natarajan, founder of Dr. V. S. Natarajan Geriatric Foundation, inaugurated the centre.

According to a press release, the facility offers a comprehensive range of services, including long-term assisted living, post-hospital recovery care, neuro-rehabilitation, palliative and end-of-life care, and respite care.

The facility is designed to provide a safe, comfortable, and med-



ically supervised environment for senior citizens and patients requiring rehabilitation and ongoing support, the release added.

The facilities include doctor consultation suites, nursing supervision, physiotherapy services, medication management, wellness

programs, and recreational spaces.

Dr. T. G. Sivaranjani, director, Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, says, “We have created a nurturing environment where seniors can live with dignity, comfort, safety, and access to professional medical support whenever needed.”



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R. RAGU

Four individuals put in a cameo every morning at Harris Road in Egmore as traffic assistants. These are not the government-recognised traffic wardens assisting the traffic police personnel on their beat, just parents seeking to streamline the flow of vehicles dropping off students at St. Anthony's Anglo-Indian High School.

Two of them see those machines through the ingate and the other two see them off the campus, through the out-gate.

This intervention is hardly recent, having been initiated by a parent 12 years ago. The parent in question Jayaseeman began regulating traffic around the school, as vehicles dropping off students were piling up on the road, partly because they were not allowed inside the campus, the decision shaped by the fact that back then the school had only one gate both for incoming and outgoing vehicles. After Jayaseeman's son completed his schooling, the baton was

passed to other parents, and the initiative has been kept humming to this day.

Among those ensuring the exercise's continuity are G. Ravi and A. Rajkumar, at this voluntary traffic beat for nine and 10 years respectively. Other notable parent volunteers are Rajila and Nagarani. Two years ago, when the management decided to create an additional gate, thereby having separate gates for incoming and outgoing vehicular traffic, these parents' work eased. But then, the rush hour never ceases to be a challenge, throwing a curveball from a quarter least expected.

Regular feedback

For a long time, these pa-

rents had been operating with the constraint of regulating vehicles right on the road, as the management was apprehensive about letting vehicles inside. These parents persisted with the request that vehicles be allowed to roll into the campus. After that request was met, another constraint continued for a long time. The school had just one gate for entry and exit. For these parent volunteers, maintaining two separate lines for incoming and outgoing vehicles took some doing.

With the campus sporting two gates over the last two years, the nature of responsibilities has changed for each volunteer. Ravi is

parked right on the road, regulating vehicles of parents and general motorists. Rajkumar is posted at the gates to watch and direct the movement of parents' vehicles. Rajila and Nagarani are at their post inside the campus, ensuring vehicles do not get "entangled" there.

Ravi points out that while regulating traffic on the road, he has experienced close shaves with vehicles whizzing past, just a hair breadth's distance away, and acrimonious outbursts from motorists that have been stopped for better movement of vehicles in and out of the campus. He shrugs it off as part of the work.

Parents in attendance

At this school on Harris Road in Egmore, a group of parents take up the responsibility of regulating traffic during the school-opening hour



G. Ravi and A. Rajkumar regulate traffic regularly on Harris Road near St Anthony's Anglo Indian High School.
PHOTOS: RAGU R

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 56th Montessori Primary Teacher Training Course later this month. The course will include online and in-person sessions, a format designed to balance work, family, and a passion for early childhood education.

The successful candidates will be awarded a diploma by the Indian Montessori Centre, Bengaluru. As an introduction, IMTC-Chennai is holding a brief online orientation and walk-in demo sessions for aspiring teachers between June 8 and 12. For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301. Visit: <https://imtcchennai.org>

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